

Chapter No. 2

Civics and Citizenship

■ Concept of civics:

The term "civics" originates from Latin word "civicus", which relates to a citizen or citizenship. The root word "civicus" means mean citizen. This connection to citizenship reflects the central focus of civics on the rights, duties and responsibilities of individuals.

The concept of civics evolved over time.

The term became widely used in late 19th and early 20th centuries as formal education system began to include civics as a subject.

► Nature and characteristics of civic:

Here are some key points about nature and characteristics of civics:-

(i) **Educational focus:** Civics is primarily educational, aimed at teaching individuals about their role, rights and duties within a society or government.

(ii) **Right and Responsibilities:** It emphasizes the balance between individuals right and responsibilities. It highlights how citizens should behave to protect their freedom, while contributing to the common good.

- (iii) **Political participation:** It covers various parts forms of political participation, such as voting, advocacy and public service.
- (iv) **Legal awareness:-** It provides knowledge of laws, rights and legal frameworks to empower individual individuals in protecting themselves and contributing to justice.
- (v) **Civic engagement:** Civic motivates individuals to participate in public life, such as voting, community service and advocacy.
- (vi) **Ethical consideration:** Civics involves discussions about ethical issues and moral responsibilities, such as social justice, equity, etc.
- (vii) **Conflict resolution:** It emphasizes the peaceful conflict resolution and cooperation within diverse societies.
- (viii) **Global perspective:** It fosters an understanding of global issues like climate change, human rights and international relations.
- (ix) **Interdisciplinary:** Civic draws from political sciences, sociology, history and law, making it a multidisciplinary field.
- (x) **Value based:** It emphasizes core values such as human rights, tolerance, equality and respect for diversity.

■ Concept of Citizenship:

Citizenship is a complex and multi-faced concept that involves rights, responsibilities and participation. It includes loyalties between an individual and a state or community.

When right of citizenship is given, then the protection of a citizen becomes a responsibility of state. Therefore, it is the duty of every citizen to respect state laws.

Citizenship is such a right of citizen by which the state adopts him and he himself stay linked/connected with state. Given the civic rights, there develops a lawful relationship among state and individual. Four conditions are necessary:

- regarding these rights:-
- An individual should show full obedience
- state should protect him
- An individual should perform all duties given by state
- An individual should have all basic rights

The concept of citizenship has expanded and diversified over time, evolving from traditional notions of legal and civic responsibilities within a state to include

various forms of participation in social, economic, environmental and digital spheres.

■ Concept of civic engagement:

Civic engagement refers to the involvement of individuals and communities in decision-making processes that affect their lives.

It encompasses a wide range of activities aimed at fostering participation in civic life. The core of civic engagement lies in encouraging citizens to play vital role in public life of their communities and to work toward collective goals for societal improvement.

► Forms of civic engagement:-

- **Voting:** Voting allows citizens to directly influence government decisions by choosing representatives in elections.
- **Grassroots movement:** Grassroots movements bring together community members to campaign for social and political change.
- **Protests and Demonstrations:** Participating in protests or rallies enables individuals to express their views on social, political or economic issues.

- o **Volunteering:** Citizens can volunteer their time and skills to assist non-profits in addressing social issues such as education, healthcare and environmental conservation.
- o **Mentoring youth:** Mentoring programs allow individuals to support and guide young people, fostering personal development, academic success and future civic participation.
- o **Petitioning:** Petitioning helps in collecting signatures to support and oppose policies or legislation.
- o **Online activism:** Digital civic engagement is very important. Using social media, blogs, or other online platforms to promote causes.
- o **Neighborhood initiatives:** Organizing local projects, such as clean-ups or block parties.
- o **Lobbying:** Lobbying involves advocating for specific legislation or policies by interacting with lawmakers to influence political decision-making process.
- o **Advocacy groups:** Joining or supporting organizations that promote specific cause.

► Nature and characteristics of civic engagement

Civic engagement encompasses various activities and attitudes that contribute to the well-being of communities and functioning of democratic systems. Here are some key aspects and of its nature and characteristics:-

◦ Active participation:

Nature: involves active engagement in community and public affairs.

Characteristics: It is proactive and requires direct action to influence/contribute.

◦ Volunteering: ^{Nature:} Civic engagement is typically voluntary and driven by personal commitment to community and societal improvement.

Characteristic: Individuals participate on base of personal value, interest, and responsibility.

◦ Community organizing:

Nature: Building and mobilizing community groups to achieve common goals.

Characteristics: It is collaborative, inclusive and often grassroots and empower communities.

◦ Educational:

Nature: Often includes a component of education and information-sharing to increase

awareness and understanding issues.

Characteristics: Involves learning about civic responsibility, public policies and way to contribute effectively.

• **Inclusivity:**

Nature: Effective civic engagement values and include diverse perspective and voices.

Characteristics: It seeks to ensure that all segments of society are represented and involved, promoting equity and social justice.

• **Personal and social impact:**

Nature: Engagement has both personal and broader social effects, influencing individuals life.

Characteristics: Engagement enhance personal growth, build social capital and contribute to overall societal progress.

• **Democratic values:**

Nature: The nature of democratic values is deeply rooted in civic engagement including equality, justice and freedom.

Characteristics: Democratic values promote civic engagement. It promotes democracy, empower citizens, encourage critical thinking and deliberation.

■ Foundation of Modern Society and Citizenship:

concept of modern society:-

Society means to live together. The word 'society' is taken from Latin 'socius' meaning 'companion'. It is the human nature that he tends to live with others. In the words of Aristotle, "Man is a social animal." For fulfilling needs human beings live together.

Modern society is advancement characterized by advancement in technology, interconnectedness through digital communication and a shift toward urbanization. It emphasizes individualism, consumerism and the pursuit of economic growth. Modern society is also marked by environmental concerns and debates around sustainability, as well as challenges related to mental health, inequality and changing nature of work in digital age.

Definitions of society:-

- "Society is an organic body and it has its own personality."
(Ibn-e-Khuldun)

- "Society is the largest group in which individuals have relationships." (A.W. Green)

Relationship between modern society and citizenship:-

The relationship between modern society and citizenship is multifaceted, reflecting the evolving dynamics of rights, responsibilities and identity in global world.

In modern society, citizenship extends beyond legal status to active participation in civic and community engagement. The concept emphasizes the role of individuals as contributors to the public good, promoting social justice, equality and democracy. Digital platforms have transformed civic participation, enabling easier access to information and activism. Modern society's fast pace and individualism can sometimes undermine communal ties, making efforts to foster strong, collaborative communities vital for a healthy and engaged citizenry.

Factors important in modern society and citizenship:-

Several factors are crucial in shaping the dynamics of modern society and citizenship. These factors influence how individuals and communities engage with their rights, responsibilities and identities with contemporary societies.

1. **Education:** Equipping individuals with knowledge about their rights, responsibilities and functioning of democratic systems is essential for active citizenship.

2. **Technology & digitalization:** Technology has transformed how people engage with society. Access to technology impacts citizen's ability to participate fully.

3. **Globalization:** Migration and global interconnectivity requires policies to accommodate diverse identities and multiple citizenship.

Globalization promotes cross-cultural understanding.

4. **Economic stability:** Economic opportunities, healthcare, housing and social welfare system directly impact the quality of citizenship.

5. **Rule and of law and governance:** Effective governance and the rule of law ensure citizen's rights are ~~not~~ protected and responsibilities are enforced. Modern societies demand greater accountability from governments and institutions fostering trust and participation.

6. **Social justice and inclusion:** Addressing inequalities based on race, gender, class and other factors is critical for an inclusive society. Modern citizenship thrives when diverse cultural, ethnic and social groups are recognized and valued.

7. **Environmental sustainability:** Citizens are increasingly expected to contribute to sustainable practices and advocate for environmental protection. Policies on waste management, renewable energy, and conservation are vital at the community level.

8. **Political engagement:** Voting, activism and public discourse are central to democratic citizenship. Inclusive political system that reflects diverse voices strengthen modern society.

9. **Freedom and rights:** Freedom of speech, religion and assembly are fundamental to citizenship. Citizenship in modern society aligns

with universal human rights principles.

10- **Security and safety:** Citizens expect protection from crime, terrorism and other threats.

As societies digitize, safeguarding personal information becomes a priority.

Conclusion:-

Modern society and citizenship are shaped by a blend of traditional and emerging factors. Balancing these aspects ensures that individuals can contribute to and benefit from their communities while addressing the challenges of globalization, technology and inequality.

■ Types of Citizenship:

Citizenship can be classified into various types. Here are the different types of citizenship commonly recognized.

(i) **Active citizenship:** Active citizenship involves individuals taking an active part/role in their communities and society. This includes like voting, volunteering and community organizing. It also help to improve society.

(ii) **Participatory citizenship:** This type of citizenship emphasizes involvement in collective decision-making processes. This is focused on participation in democratic institutions and community dialogues. It shapes society.

(iii) **Digital citizenship:** Digital citizenship refers to the responsible, ethical and effective use of technology by individuals to engage in society, politics and communication online. Digital citizenship has become essential for participating in modern world.

(iv) **Global citizenship:** Global citizenship recognises shared global responsibilities and interconnectedness. It includes international cooperation, human right advocacy and environmental awareness. It extends beyond borders.

(v) **Ecological/Environmental citizenship:** It is centered on the responsibility to protect the environment and promote sustainability. It emphasizes the role citizens play in conserving natural resources and protecting the planet for future generations.

(vi) **Economic citizenship:** Economic citizenship relates to the rights and responsibilities of citizens in economic spheres, particularly concerning access to economic resources, financial literacy and the ability to participate in economy.

(vii) **Participatory citizenship:** It refers to the positive and active engagement of citizens

in their communities and societies to promote common good. It involves active participation, critical thinking, inclusivity and accountability.

(viii) **Cultural citizenship:** Cultural citizenship focuses on the rights of individuals to participate in and contribute to the cultural life of their community and society. It emphasizes the ability of citizens to express their cultural traditions, languages and beliefs freely and without discrimination.